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” SENSU ”
A TAXONOMIC TERM TO
HELP FIGHT
RSE-DEFINITION
CONFUSION

Use "Sensu" Today:
sort your scope out
and get concept-clarity

github.com/FlicAnderson/sensu-IRSC26

You may have
experienced
CONFUSION
about the term:

” RESEARCH
SOFTWARE
ENGINEER ”
(RSE)

Who are RSEs, and how can they be identified?

You may have heard people discussing:

- ❖ Inclusive definitions (US-RSE / Society of RSEs)
- ❖ Activity-based definitions
- ❖ Motivation-based definitions

Are most RSEs *sure* they are RSEs?

Could using "Sensu" be Right For You?



Does YOUR work ask...

What do we know about RSEs?

How can we support them?

What challenges do RSEs face?

Do YOU aim to **find RSEs** or **engage them** in
your work...

... but struggle to clarify

'which type' of RSEs

your project addresses?

PROPOSING "SENSU"

'Sensu' is a **Latin** word
meaning "**in the sense of**"

*Used in various and diverse
fields e.g. biological taxonomy for the
avoidance of confusion, to:*

*... specify **Scope or Source**
of **Concepts or Names***

”Sensu lato” :

”in the **broad** sense (s.l.) ”

... RSE (s.l.) as inclusive umbrella term

from scientist-coders to research software
specialists and everyone in-between!

”Sensu stricto” :

”in the **strict** sense (s.s.) ”

... RSE (s.s.) for narrower cases

e.g. full-time job role providing computational
support for academics

Sensu can also be *combined* with an ***authority or source!***

For example:

”... RSE sensu US-RSE ...”

”... RSE sensu Goth et al. 2024 ”

BENEFITS:

- *Avoid confusion* amidst many RSE definitions
- *Find* the kind of RSEs you're looking for
- *Save time and energy*

You too could feel:

"Sensu" frees us to use our skills to address the complex challenges faced by
RSEs of ALL Definitions!

Use "sensu" today in your discussions about RSEs; *feel the difference* it makes in every conversation!

For more information about using "sensu", please consult a local taxonomist or Flic Anderson for details.

” SENSU ”: (TL; DR)

Helps your audience understand **exactly which RSEs** your guidelines, policy, research findings or participation invitations are designed to benefit:

Use **”sensu lato”** for the **broader**, more inclusive umbrella term (e.g. ”RSE s.l.”).

Use **”sensu stricto”** when communicating a **narrower** concept (e.g. ”RSE s.s.”).